

from a number of capable sources (which we shall later discuss in detail). The first generation Apple TV was released ten years ago in 2007 and was based on MAC OS X10 Tiger. This was a time when smartphones were not what they are today, and even touchscreen phones weren't commonplace. With the progress made over the years by iOS, Apple decided with their fourth generation of the Apple TV in 2015 that the device would now run on a new OS specifically designed for the home television. This Operating System was tvOS.

In last month's FastTrack we took a deep dive into the hardware side of the Apple TV. This time we shall discuss the software that runs on these tiny streaming boxes. We shall also look in-depth at how technology has changed the software capabilities of the Apple TV over the years and how Apple constantly innovated on its inherent UX principles to keep pace with the market.

The Apple TV

The 1st generation Apple TV was shipped in 2007 and the 160 GB HDD model was released in May 2007. At this time you needed a computer with iTunes to sync content with it. This changed in 2008 when a software upgrade was announced that would make Apple TV a standalone device. You could control the Apple TV with your iTunes remote app running on the iPhone or iPod Touch. You could now stream your videos from your iPads and iPhones seamlessly to your TV screen via the Apple TV. Also, television centered apps started filling the App Store and the device started gaining popularity.

The second generation Apple TV was better designed to the user's needs in the sense that it did not have a huge internal hard disk. Instead, it had 8 GB of flash memory, which was enough for buffering. The media had to be streamed from iOS devices instead of being synced. This went hand in hand with the Airplay feature which allowed seamless streaming of rented or owned content from the various devices.

The following generations of the Apple TV was basically improved in terms of the quality of video they could stream and hardware upgrades. For a detailed look at these improvements feel free to go back to the Apple TV chapter in Part 1 of this FT.

When in 2015 the fourth generation was announced, it came with the tvOS. Tim Cook while making the launch announcement reaffirmed his belief that the future of TV is going to be Apps. The tvOS would provide